

Paid Android Market

Google has enabled paid apps in the Market for Android devices in India in mid-October

Glass-free 3D TVs coming

Toshiba plans to launch 3D TVs later this year that don't require those shoddy glasses

Q&A

Messed up drives, flooded mailboxes and quickly deflating

Digit QnA helps you undo all these, and more..

Direct3D device errors while playing games

My computer has Windows XP SP3 installed on it with 1GB of RAM. I installed a game called 'Quadro Racing' from your August 2010 DVD. However, after installing it, when I tried to run it, it shows the following error and then terminates - 'Could not create Direct3DDevice9! (error: D3DERR_INVALIDCALL)'

Nisarg Shah



Direct3D errors showing up while playing games

The error you are seeing either could be due to drivers, or simply because your card does not support the game. We recommend you to download the latest drivers for your graphics card from the manufacturer's web site. If that doesn't work, you'll need to replace your graphics card.

Battery drops to 42 per cent in a second

Last year, I bought a Compaq Presario laptop (model NO. CQ40 301TU) It came with 1GB RAM, 160 GB hard disk and an Intel Celeron dual-core processor. Last month, I formatted my system and installed Windows Vista Home. Since then, I've got a problem with my system. As soon as I unplug the power, my battery level instantly comes down to 42 per cent from 100 per cent. It's been happening for some time now.

Pankaj Bharvey
Ujjain

It's important to see if the battery still ends up powering the laptop as long as it normally does. If it does, then there isn't much to worry about. It might be just a problem with the readings. If the battery isn't lasting long enough, then the laptop might have a failing battery. If that is the case, you'll have to take it to the service centre and ask them to help you get a new one. There's also a chance of the charger being faulty.

Chaos, thanks to virus

I came across this virus two days ago and it has been infecting every executable file on my computer. Currently, I am using Windows 7 along with Microsoft Security Essentials. I feel it isn't very good, but I have no other options. I scanned my PC with it and it showed nearly 10 to 20 files in the temporary folder affected with virus names such as:

"Virus:Win32/Parite.B"

According to Microsoft Security Essentials, all the viruses have been removed from my system. But when I scanned my system again, selecting the whole hard disk as the option, I saw the same virus present everywhere in my C partition.

Installation of games and even flash games are corrupted. The virus - "Virus:Win32/Parite.B" has attached itself to the files, so I have removed them. But on rescanning, it was there again. The only files with viruses are music and video files.

Himanshu Prakash Pal

It's difficult to give a foolproof solution to your problem. If Microsoft Security Essentials isn't removing the virus from your PC, then you need to find an alternative. Try a different anti-virus or security suite software such as Norton Internet Security, ESET NOD32 or Kaspersky anti-virus.

System ready for GeForce GTS450

Can I install NVIDIA's GeForce GTS450 graphics card on my ASUS M2N68-AM PLUS motherboard?

My system configuration is:
AMD Athlon II X2 240 Processor 2.80 GHz. 2 GB RAM, 320 GB HDD, 450 W power supply and graphics card is MSI 9400 GT 1 GB.

Bhva Tiwari

Yes, you can install NVIDIA GTS450 on your system.

Dummy Windows installation

My PC's configuration is as follows:
Intel Core 2 Duo E7500 2.93 GHz, 4 GB Kingston RAM, 500 GB Seagate hard drive, Biostar GeForce 9400 GT 1 GB Graphics Card, ASUS DVD-RW, 450 W SMPS, Samsung SyncMaster B2030 (20-inch), Windows XP Professional SP3

When I was installing Windows on my computer, it started installing the OS in the D: drive, so I manually switched it off. Finally, I successfully installed Windows on the C: drive. When I restarted my PC, the boot menu showed two operating systems.

The first instance of Windows worked properly on booting, but the second one was the dummy one created by forcibly powering off my PC during installation. I once again formatted my C: drive, but the problem remains. How can I directly boot to the first OS without seeing the boot menu?

Whenever I check my Computer System properties, it shows 3 GB of RAM. In the system BIOS menu, it shows 4 GB. Why is it so? What is the best resolution to run games such as Splinter Cell: Conviction and Assassin's Creed II to run smooth?

Abhigyan